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- **Definition 1:** A point (or an element) $\mathbf{x}^* \in \Omega$ is called a local minimum (maximum) of f if there exists an $\epsilon > 0$, such that $\mathbf{x} \in \Omega$ and $\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}^*\| < \epsilon$ implies $f(\mathbf{x}^*) \leq f(\mathbf{x})$ ($f(\mathbf{x}^*) \geq f(\mathbf{x})$) .

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- **Definition 2:** A point $\mathbf{x}^* \in \Omega$ is called a global minimum (maximum) of f if $f(\mathbf{x}^*) \leq f(\mathbf{x})$ ($f(\mathbf{x}^*) \geq f(\mathbf{x})$) for all $\mathbf{x} \in \Omega$.

- **Definition 3:** A vector $\mathbf{d} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $\mathbf{d} \neq \mathbf{0}$ is said to be a **feasible direction** at $\mathbf{x}^* \in \Omega$, if there exists a $c > 0$ such that for all t , $0 \leq t \leq c$, $\mathbf{x}^* + t\mathbf{d} \in \Omega$.

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- At $[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}]^T$ any $\mathbf{d} \in \mathbb{R}^2$ will be a feasible direction.

First order necessary conditions for a local minimum

- **Remark 1:** If $\mathbf{x}^*$ is an **interior point** of Ω then any $\mathbf{d} \in \mathbb{R}^n, \mathbf{d} \neq \mathbf{0}$ is a feasible direction at $\mathbf{x}^*$.

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- The necessary condition of **Theorem 1** is not sufficient for a local minimum

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- Check that f has a **global minimum** at $x_1 = \frac{1}{2}, x_2 = 0$

Second order necessary conditions for a point to be a local minimum

- **Theorem 3:** Let $f : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a **twice continuously differentiable** function (that is all the second order partial derivatives of f (given by $\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_j \partial x_i}$) exists and are continuous as functions from Ω to $\mathbb{R}$).

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- For example the **0** matrix has all n eigenvalues equal to 0, the identity matrix I_n has all n eigenvalues equal to 1, and for an **upper triangular matrix**, the diagonal entries are its eigenvalues.

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- **Remark:** A nonsingular (nonzero determinant) **positive semidefinite matrix** is **positive definite**.

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Hence f is **not a convex function** on Ω .

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- **Remark :** Since minimizing f is same as maximizing $-f$, all the previous theorems for **minimizing a convex function** have corresponding analogues for **maximizing a concave function**.

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- **Theorem 6:** Let f be a **convex function** defined on a **closed** and **bounded convex set** Ω (so it has at least one extreme point), then there exists an extreme point of Ω , where f takes its **maximum** value.